

## Acute Bacterial Bronchitis (chest service)

Patient Group Direction, version 002, issued 7 September 2026. Three arms: doxycycline, amoxicillin, clarithromycin

### Scope of this PGD

This PGD authorises the supply of an oral antibiotic for acute bacterial bronchitis in patients aged 12 years and over who meet the inclusion criteria and whose observations are within the thresholds in Appendix 1.

- Doxycycline is first line in adults. Amoxicillin is used in patients aged 12 to 17 and in pregnancy. Clarithromycin is used only where the first-line agent is unsuitable and the patient has a penicillin allergy.
- **Every observation in Appendix 1 must be measured and recorded before any supply, and a CRB-65 score calculated. If any threshold is breached, refer.**
- **Most patients presenting with an acute cough do not need an antibiotic. The inclusion criteria are deliberately narrow.**
- One course per episode. A second course is not authorised under this PGD.

## Arm 1 — Doxycycline (first line, adults)

**Patient Group Direction for the supply of doxycycline 100mg capsules for acute bacterial bronchitis in adults aged 18 years and over.**

### Healthcare professionals covered, and training

- Pharmacist registered and practising with the GPhC.
- Pharmacy technician registered and practising with the GPhC. None of these medicines is a controlled drug, so registered pharmacy technicians may lawfully supply under this PGD (Human Medicines Regulations 2012 as amended, 26 June 2024).
- Must have completed training relevant to this condition, documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.
- Must be competent in measuring and recording oxygen saturation on a validated pulse oximeter, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and in applying the thresholds in Appendix 1.
- Must be able to calculate and apply a CRB-65 score.
- Must previously have used PGDs to supply medication.
- Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer and practise only within the bounds of their own competence.

### The PGD

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| <b>Indication</b>                      | Acute bacterial bronchitis in adults aged 18 and over meeting the inclusion criteria below. First-line agent for adults.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Aged 18 years and over.</li><li>• <b>PURULENT SPUTUM (yellow or green), AND EITHER a higher-risk comorbidity (chronic lung disease including COPD and asthma, heart failure, diabetes, chronic kidney or liver disease, immunosuppression, or age 65 and over) OR symptoms persisting beyond 14 days.</b></li><li>• <b>All observations within the thresholds in Appendix 1, and CRB-65 score of 0.</b></li><li>• Valid informed consent given.</li><li>• No exclusion criterion present.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b>              | <b>Refer, do not supply, where any of the following is present.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>SUSPECTED PNEUMONIA: focal chest signs (dull percussion note, bronchial breathing, coarse crackles that do not clear with coughing) with any systemic feature.</b></li><li>• <b>Any observation outside the thresholds in Appendix 1, or CRB-65 score of 1 or more.</b></li><li>• <b>SpO2 below 94% on air at rest.</b></li><li>• <b>Severely systemically unwell, however the observations read. If the patient looks unwell to you, refer.</b></li><li>• Haemoptysis, or a cough lasting more than 3 weeks in a current or former smoker.</li><li>• Suspected pulmonary embolism, heart failure or lung cancer.</li><li>• An antibiotic already taken for this episode. One course per episode.</li><li>• Under 18 years of age. Use the amoxicillin arm.</li><li>• Pregnancy or breastfeeding. Doxycycline is contraindicated; refer.</li><li>• Hypersensitivity to doxycycline or other tetracyclines.</li><li>• Known severe hepatic impairment.</li></ul> |
| <b>Cautions</b>                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Photosensitivity: advise sun protection.</li><li>• Separate from antacids, iron and dairy by at least 2 hours.</li><li>• Potentiates warfarin; where the patient is anticoagulated, refer rather than supply.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Actions if excluded or declines</b> | Explain why an antibiotic cannot be supplied. Refer same-day where any Appendix 1 threshold is breached or pneumonia is suspected. Give self-care                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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|  | and safety-netting advice. Document the advice and the decision, and inform the GP where the reason for exclusion is a new clinical finding such as a low SpO <sub>2</sub> . |
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## The medicine

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| <b>Name, form and strength</b>  | Doxycycline 100mg capsules.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Legal category</b>           | POM.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Route and method</b>         | Oral. Swallow whole with plenty of water, sitting or standing, and well before lying down, to avoid oesophageal irritation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>       | 200mg on day 1 as a single dose, then 100mg once daily for a further 4 days. Total 5 days.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Quantity to be supplied</b>  | 6 capsules. (2 on day 1, then 1 daily for 4 days.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Maximum treatment period</b> | 5 days.<br><b>One course per episode. A second course is not authorised under this PGD; refer.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>          | Common: nausea, diarrhoea, photosensitivity. Uncommon: oesophageal irritation or ulceration, rash. Rare: Clostridioides difficile infection, hepatotoxicity, benign intracranial hypertension.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Yellow Card reporting</b>    | Report suspected adverse reactions via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• That valid informed consent was given.</li> <li>• Patient name, address, date of birth, and the GP with whom they are registered.</li> <li>• The full set of observations from Appendix 1, including SpO<sub>2</sub>, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and the CRB-65 score.</li> <li>• Which inclusion feature was met (purulent sputum plus comorbidity, or purulent sputum plus duration).</li> <li>• Name and registration number of the healthcare professional supplying.</li> <li>• Name of the medicine, date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied.</li> <li>• Batch number and expiry date.</li> <li>• Advice given, including advice given if excluded or declining treatment.</li> <li>• Details of any adverse drug reactions and the actions taken.</li> <li>• That the medicine was supplied under this PGD.</li> </ul> <p>Records signed, dated, legible and contemporaneous. Adults: 8 years. Under 18s: until the 25th birthday.</p> |
| <b>Storage</b>                  | Store below 25C.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## Information for the patient

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| <b>Written information</b> | Supply the doxycycline patient information leaflet.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Counselling</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Take with plenty of water, sitting or standing up, and do not lie down for 30 minutes afterwards.</li> <li>• Avoid antacids, indigestion remedies, iron tablets and milk within 2 hours of a dose.</li> <li>• You may burn more easily in the sun. Use sun protection.</li> <li>• <b>Seek help the same day if you become breathless, develop chest</b></li> </ul> |

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|                  | <p><b>pain, cough blood, or feel much worse at any point. Do not wait to finish the course.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Come back if you are no better 5 to 7 days after finishing.</li> </ul>                                                 |
| <b>Follow-up</b> | <p>Seek advice if breathlessness, chest pain or fever develop, if symptoms worsen at any point, or if there is no improvement within 5 to 7 days of finishing the course. A cough alone may take three weeks to settle and is not by itself a reason to return.</p> |

## Arm 2 — Amoxicillin (12 to 17 years, and in pregnancy)

Patient Group Direction for the supply of amoxicillin 500mg capsules for acute bacterial bronchitis in patients aged 12 to 17 years, and in pregnant women aged 18 and over.

### Healthcare professionals covered, and training

- Pharmacist registered and practising with the GPhC.
- Pharmacy technician registered and practising with the GPhC. None of these medicines is a controlled drug, so registered pharmacy technicians may lawfully supply under this PGD (Human Medicines Regulations 2012 as amended, 26 June 2024).
- Must have completed training relevant to this condition, documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.
- Must be competent in measuring and recording oxygen saturation on a validated pulse oximeter, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and in applying the thresholds in Appendix 1.
- Must be able to calculate and apply a CRB-65 score.
- Must previously have used PGDs to supply medication.
- Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer and practise only within the bounds of their own competence.

### The PGD

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| Indication                      | Acute bacterial bronchitis in patients aged 12 to 17 years, and in pregnant women, where doxycycline is unsuitable.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Inclusion criteria              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Aged 12 years and over.</li><li>• <b>PURULENT SPUTUM (yellow or green), AND EITHER a higher-risk comorbidity (chronic lung disease including COPD and asthma, heart failure, diabetes, chronic kidney or liver disease, immunosuppression, or age 65 and over) OR symptoms persisting beyond 14 days.</b></li><li>• <b>All observations within the thresholds in Appendix 1, and CRB-65 score of 0.</b></li><li>• Valid informed consent given.</li><li>• No exclusion criterion present.</li><li>• Either aged 12 to 17 years, or pregnant and aged 18 or over.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Exclusion criteria              | <b>Refer, do not supply, where any of the following is present.</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>SUSPECTED PNEUMONIA: focal chest signs (dull percussion note, bronchial breathing, coarse crackles that do not clear with coughing) with any systemic feature.</b></li><li>• <b>Any observation outside the thresholds in Appendix 1, or CRB-65 score of 1 or more.</b></li><li>• <b>SpO2 below 94% on air at rest.</b></li><li>• <b>Severely systemically unwell, however the observations read. If the patient looks unwell to you, refer.</b></li><li>• Haemoptysis, or a cough lasting more than 3 weeks in a current or former smoker.</li><li>• Suspected pulmonary embolism, heart failure or lung cancer.</li><li>• An antibiotic already taken for this episode. One course per episode.</li><li>• Known penicillin or beta-lactam allergy.</li><li>• Infectious mononucleosis or acute lymphoblastic leukaemia.</li><li>• eGFR below 30. Refer.</li></ul> |
| Cautions                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>Amoxicillin may be used in pregnancy where clinically indicated. This is the reason this arm exists.</b></li><li>• Advise that any rash should stop the course and prompt review.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Actions if excluded or declines | As Arm 1. A pregnant woman with penicillin allergy needs a macrolide, which is not available to her under this PGD; refer to the GP. Erythromycin is the agent usually preferred in pregnancy and is not covered here.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## The medicine

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| <b>Name, form and strength</b>  | Amoxicillin 500mg capsules.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Legal category</b>           | POM.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Route and method</b>         | Oral. Swallow whole with water. Absorption is unaffected by food.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>       | 500mg three times a day for 5 days.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Quantity to be supplied</b>  | 15 capsules.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Maximum treatment period</b> | 5 days.<br><b>One course per episode. A second course is not authorised; refer.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>          | Very common: diarrhoea, nausea. Common: rash, candidiasis. Rare but serious: anaphylaxis, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, C. difficile infection, cholestatic jaundice.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Yellow Card reporting</b>    | Report suspected adverse reactions via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• That valid informed consent was given.</li><li>• Patient name, address, date of birth, and the GP with whom they are registered.</li><li>• The full set of observations from Appendix 1, including SpO<sub>2</sub>, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and the CRB-65 score.</li><li>• Which inclusion feature was met (purulent sputum plus comorbidity, or purulent sputum plus duration).</li><li>• Name and registration number of the healthcare professional supplying.</li><li>• Name of the medicine, date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied.</li><li>• Batch number and expiry date.</li><li>• Advice given, including advice given if excluded or declining treatment.</li><li>• Details of any adverse drug reactions and the actions taken.</li><li>• That the medicine was supplied under this PGD.</li></ul> Records signed, dated, legible and contemporaneous. Adults: 8 years. Under 18s: until the 25th birthday. |
| <b>Storage</b>                  | Store below 25C.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

## Information for the patient

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| <b>Written information</b> | Supply the amoxicillin patient information leaflet.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Counselling</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Take one capsule three times a day and finish the course.</li><li>• <b>Stop and seek urgent help if you develop a rash, wheeze, or swelling of the lips or tongue.</b></li><li>• <b>Seek help the same day if you become breathless, develop chest pain, cough blood, or feel much worse.</b></li><li>• Come back if you are no better 5 to 7 days after finishing.</li></ul> |
| <b>Follow-up</b>           | As Arm 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Arm 3 — Clarithromycin (penicillin allergy, or where doxycycline is unsuitable)

Patient Group Direction for the supply of clarithromycin 250mg tablets for acute bacterial bronchitis where doxycycline and amoxicillin are both unsuitable.

### Healthcare professionals covered, and training

- Pharmacist registered and practising with the GPhC.
- Pharmacy technician registered and practising with the GPhC. None of these medicines is a controlled drug, so registered pharmacy technicians may lawfully supply under this PGD (Human Medicines Regulations 2012 as amended, 26 June 2024).
- Must have completed training relevant to this condition, documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.
- Must be competent in measuring and recording oxygen saturation on a validated pulse oximeter, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and in applying the thresholds in Appendix 1.
- Must be able to calculate and apply a CRB-65 score.
- Must previously have used PGDs to supply medication.
- Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer and practise only within the bounds of their own competence.

### The PGD

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| Indication         | Acute bacterial bronchitis where doxycycline is unsuitable and the patient has a penicillin allergy, in patients aged 12 years and over who are not pregnant.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Inclusion criteria | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Aged 12 years and over.</li><li>• <b>PURULENT SPUTUM (yellow or green), AND EITHER a higher-risk comorbidity (chronic lung disease including COPD and asthma, heart failure, diabetes, chronic kidney or liver disease, immunosuppression, or age 65 and over) OR symptoms persisting beyond 14 days.</b></li><li>• <b>All observations within the thresholds in Appendix 1, and CRB-65 score of 0.</b></li><li>• Valid informed consent given.</li><li>• No exclusion criterion present.</li><li>• <b>Doxycycline unsuitable AND penicillin allergy present.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Exclusion criteria | <p><b>Refer, do not supply, where any of the following is present.</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>SUSPECTED PNEUMONIA: focal chest signs (dull percussion note, bronchial breathing, coarse crackles that do not clear with coughing) with any systemic feature.</b></li><li>• <b>Any observation outside the thresholds in Appendix 1, or CRB-65 score of 1 or more.</b></li><li>• <b>SpO2 below 94% on air at rest.</b></li><li>• <b>Severely systemically unwell, however the observations read. If the patient looks unwell to you, refer.</b></li><li>• Haemoptysis, or a cough lasting more than 3 weeks in a current or former smoker.</li><li>• Suspected pulmonary embolism, heart failure or lung cancer.</li><li>• An antibiotic already taken for this episode. One course per episode.</li><li>• Pregnancy or breastfeeding. Refer.</li><li>• Hypersensitivity to macrolides.</li><li>• Concurrent ergot alkaloids, oral midazolam, lomitapide, astemizole, cisapride, domperidone, pimozide, terfenadine, ticagrelor, ivabradine, ranolazine, simvastatin or lovastatin.</li><li>• Known QT prolongation, or concurrent QT-prolonging medicines.</li><li>• Known electrolyte disturbance, or severe hepatic impairment.</li><li>• Taking warfarin or a DOAC. Refer.</li></ul> |
| Cautions           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Colchicine: risk of toxicity. Refer rather than supply.</li><li>• Advise on the potential for dizziness, vertigo and confusion.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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| <b>Actions if excluded or declines</b> | As Arm 1. |
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## The medicine

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| <b>Name, form and strength</b>  | Clarithromycin 250mg film-coated tablets.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Legal category</b>           | POM.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Route and method</b>         | Oral. Swallow whole with water, with or without food.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>       | 250mg twice daily for 5 days.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Quantity to be supplied</b>  | 10 tablets.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Maximum treatment period</b> | 5 days.<br><b>One course per episode. A second course is not authorised; refer.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>          | Common: abdominal pain, nausea, diarrhoea, taste disturbance, headache.<br>Uncommon: QT prolongation, hepatic dysfunction. Rare: C. difficile infection, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, ototoxicity.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Yellow Card reporting</b>    | Report suspected adverse reactions via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• That valid informed consent was given.</li> <li>• Patient name, address, date of birth, and the GP with whom they are registered.</li> <li>• The full set of observations from Appendix 1, including SpO<sub>2</sub>, respiratory rate, pulse, blood pressure and temperature, and the CRB-65 score.</li> <li>• Which inclusion feature was met (purulent sputum plus comorbidity, or purulent sputum plus duration).</li> <li>• Name and registration number of the healthcare professional supplying.</li> <li>• Name of the medicine, date of supply, dose, form, route and quantity supplied.</li> <li>• Batch number and expiry date.</li> <li>• Advice given, including advice given if excluded or declining treatment.</li> <li>• Details of any adverse drug reactions and the actions taken.</li> <li>• That the medicine was supplied under this PGD.</li> </ul> <p>Records signed, dated, legible and contemporaneous. Adults: 8 years. Under 18s: until the 25th birthday.</p> |
| <b>Storage</b>                  | Store below 25C.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## Information for the patient

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| <b>Written information</b> | Supply the clarithromycin patient information leaflet.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Counselling</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Take one tablet twice a day for five days and finish the course.</li> <li>• Tell us or your GP before starting any new medicine while taking this.</li> <li>• <b>Seek help the same day if you become breathless, develop chest pain, cough blood, or feel much worse.</b></li> <li>• Come back if you are no better 5 to 7 days after finishing.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Follow-up</b>           | As Arm 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## Appendix 1 — Observations, thresholds and CRB-65

Every observation below must be measured and recorded before any supply. If ANY threshold is breached, or CRB-65 is 1 or more, do not supply: refer.

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| Oxygen saturation      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Measure SpO2 on air, at rest, after 5 minutes, on a validated pulse oximeter with an adequate trace.</li><li>• <b>REFER if SpO2 is below 94%.</b></li><li>• For a patient with known COPD, refer if SpO2 has fallen below their own documented baseline.</li></ul> |
| Respiratory rate       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Count for a full 60 seconds.</li><li>• <b>REFER if 22 or above.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Pulse                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>REFER if above 110 at rest.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Blood pressure         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>REFER if systolic below 100.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Temperature            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>REFER if 38C or above.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Level of consciousness | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <b>REFER on any new confusion, disorientation or drowsiness.</b></li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                         |

### CRB-65

Score 1 point for each of the following.

- Confusion: new disorientation in person, place or time.
- Respiratory rate 30 or more.
- Blood pressure: systolic below 90, or diastolic 60 or less.
- Age 65 or over.

**Score 0: low risk. May be treated under this PGD if all other criteria are met.**

**Score 1 or 2: increased risk of death. Do not supply. Refer for same-day assessment.**

**Score 3 or more: high risk. Do not supply. Arrange urgent hospital assessment.**

### Refer regardless of any score

- Focal chest signs suggesting pneumonia.
- Haemoptysis.
- Cyanosis.
- Stridor or absent breath sounds.
- Accessory muscle use.
- Peripheral oedema with weight gain.
- Persistent hoarseness, or a cough over 3 weeks in a smoker.
- The patient simply looks unwell to you.

### Authorisation

|                 |                  |
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| Version         | v002             |
| Supersedes      | Version 001      |
| Valid from date | 7 September 2026 |
| Expiry date     | 31 July 2027     |

|                   |                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Doctor</b>     | Name: Nitin Shori<br>Job title: Medical Director, Get Real Health<br>GMC: 6047293<br><b>Signed: N. Shori</b><br>Date: 7 September 2026           |
| <b>Pharmacist</b> | Name: Chris Pilkington<br>Job title: Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health<br>GPhC: 2046322<br><b>Signed: C. Pilkington</b><br>Date: 7 September 2026 |

*Both authorising signatories reviewed this version together on 7 September 2026 and gave their authorisation for it to be issued. Signatures were applied digitally on their joint instruction, which is the established process for Get Real Health PGDs.*

### **Adoption by the employing organisation**

*To be completed by the adopting pharmacy. These signatories are the adopting organisation own signatories and must not be pre-filled by Get Real Health.*

|                                       |                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Superintendent / clinical lead</b> | Name: .....<br>Job title and organisation: .....<br>Signature: .....<br>Date: ..... |
| <b>Professional group signatory</b>   | Name: .....<br>Job title and organisation: .....<br>Signature: .....<br>Date: ..... |

Change history

|         |                                                                                     |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Version | v002                                                                                |
| Date    | 7 September 2026                                                                    |
| Changes | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Full clinical review and reissue.</li></ul> |